A Market for Human Expertise: Observations[*†]

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Abstract

The market for human expertise to train AI is among the fastest-growing marketplaces and cited as a primary source of new work created by AI, with potential to contribute 19B to GDP by 2030.[1] We use daily data from a leading platform where multiple AI labs purchase expertise, covering 213,000 hires and an estimated $540 million in pay out at posted rates between November 2025 and September 2026, to ask how the market for expertise-as-training-data compares to the market for expertise-as-labor. We find evidence that new hires and wages for expertise-as-training-data in a domain fall as the accumulated corpus of expertise grows. Demand for domain-specific expertise arrive in successive waves: most postings attain the majority of their eventual hiring in our window within four weeks of first posting and then new hiring subsides. On average, global wages start above the US full-time equivalent for the same narrow occupation, and decline over time. Domains hired later are those with larger gaps between potential and observed AI use. We interpret these patterns through a model in which a buyer accumulates stocks of human expertise (training data) in two complementary domains, facing diminishing returns and a per-period upward-sloping supply of expertise. The buyer acquires foundational expertise first, paying above experts' reservation wage to build the stock quickly then reduces both hiring and pay as the stock grows. The accumulated stock of foundational expertise raises the value of specialized expertise, which is extracted later in a wave of its own.

Data Description

We examine the complete public job board of a leading platform where AI labs buy expertise daily between November 11, 2025 and September 12, 2026. Each snapshot records the job title,

[*]This paper is frequently updated with new data.

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[1]The Economic Impact of the Data Annotation Industry, Oxford Economics, December 2025, url = `https://www.oxfordeconomics.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/12/OxfordEconomics_DataAnnotationImpacts.pdf`, accessed Aug 20, 2026.

the pay, a persistent posting identifier, and a counter of the form "N hired this month." The counter is a rolling sum: it reports the posting's hires over the trailing 31 days. Day-over-day change incorporates both the current day's new hires with the exits from 31 days earlier. We recover daily hires by adjusting the counter's daily change for these exits.[2] Summing across the panel's 2,348 postings amounts to roughly 213,000 hires, including about 7,000 hired in the month before the panel (Appendix A), with estimated compensation of $540 million at posted rates.[3]

The platform classifies 78% of jobs into 12 occupational domains, and we further map each job to the 2018 Standard Occupational Classification, using the detailed SOC-6 descriptions and linguistic similarities to the job descriptions.[4] We assign all postings to an SOC-2 digit major group using a hierarchical classifier applied to job titles and descriptions. We also collect the following details from each posting: education and experience requirements, the stated time commitment, and the form of compensation: a time rate (hourly, weekly, or yearly) or a fixed payment (one-time or per task), together with the range or amount specified and whether the posting's text offers a cash bonus or merit-based escalation of pay. We observe each posting's location terms: whether a location is required, the eligible or excluded countries, and whether the work is remote or on-site. Finally, we merge in occupation-level education and experience requirements from the Occupational Information Network (O*NET) and occupation-level wages and employment from the BLS Occupational Employment and Wage Statistics (OEWS).

For AI-use measures we use the occupation-level series of the Anthropic Economic Index, released March 5, 2026. *Observed AI use* is the share of each occupation's task time observably performed with AI, constructed by Massenkoff and McCrory (2026) from Anthropic usage logs. *Theoretical AI use* is the share of an occupation's task time that frontier models could plausibly perform, taken from the human-rated full-exposure series of Eloundou et al. (2023). The *AI adoption gap* is theoretical minus observed use, i.e., the portion of feasible AI use that has not yet materialized.

Obs. 1: Hiring proceeds in successive waves for domains of expertise.

Figure 1 plots daily new hires for the work domains on the platform. Each series is scaled to its own peak, with domains ordered by the hires-weighted mean date of hiring, putting the latest

[2] Appendix A states the recursion and its starting conditions.

[3] The compensation estimate combines reconstructed hires with posted rates under assumed engagement lengths. For hourly postings, we assume one week of work, using the listing's median reported weekly hours from the platform's structured field where available (45% of hourly postings) and 40 hours otherwise. For postings classified as task-based or one-time, we assign one payment per hire at the listing's median posted amount. Assuming 40 hours for every hourly hire, while leaving other pay categories unchanged, gives $687 million; paying each hourly hire for the length its posting states, and 23 days when it states none (Table 4), gives $2.7 billion.

[4] All hires in the cleaned sample are on titles coded to a detailed six-digit SOC occupation.

wave at the top. The platform labels twelve work domains, with eleven exceeding 1,000 hires over the nine-month panel. Two features of these data are worth emphasizing.

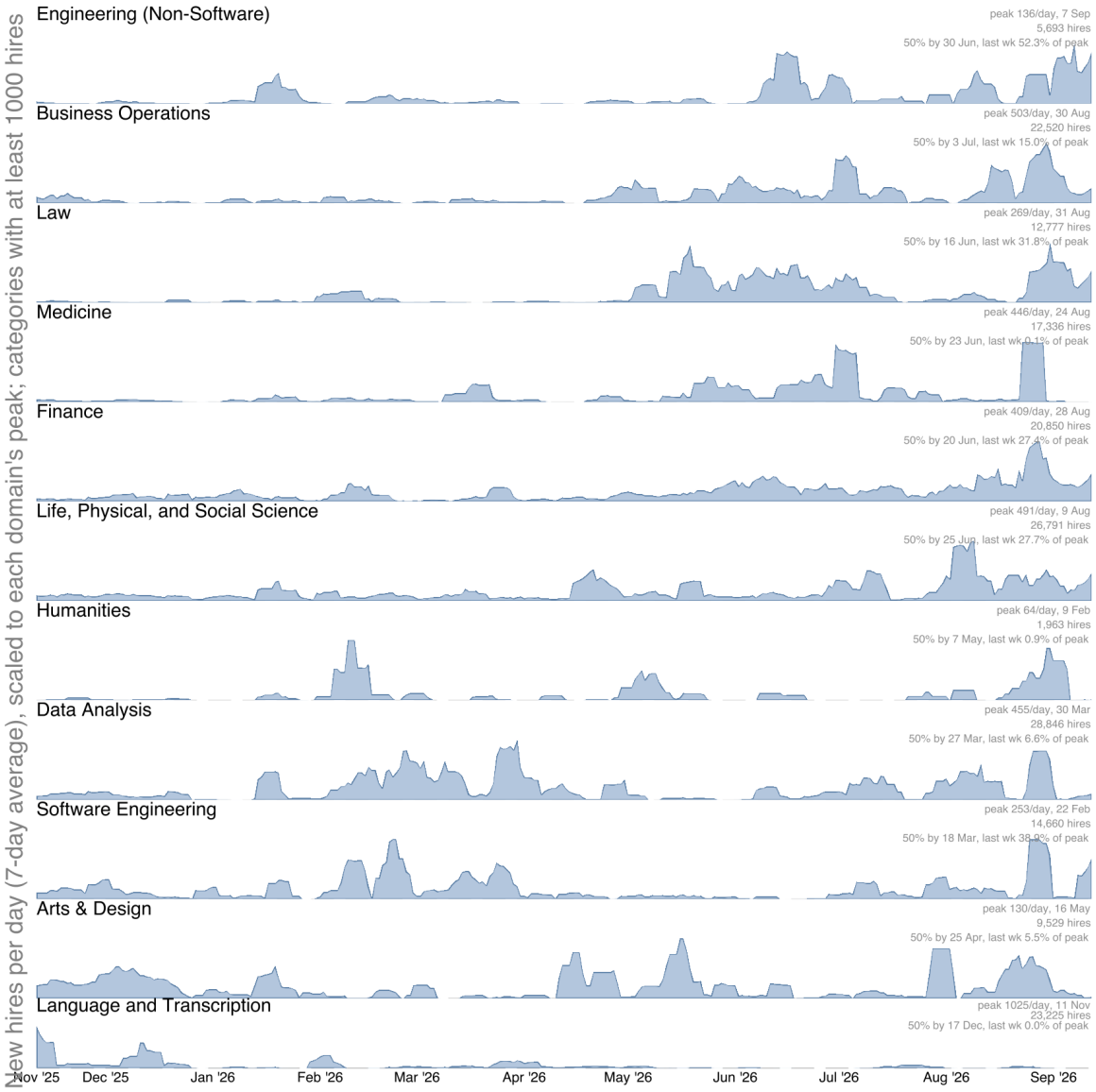


Figure 1: Hiring waves by the talent-sourcing platform's own listing-domain tag, categories with at least 1,000 hires. Rows ordered by the hires-weighted mean hiring date. Right-hand labels report each domain's peak daily hiring rate and its date, total hires, the day its cumulative hiring reaches half of its window total, and the final week's average daily rate as a share of the peak.

First, within most domains, hiring arrives in waves, rising steeply, peaking, then declining. Across postings, the majority (54%) of eventual hiring over the ten month window occurs within the first four weeks of the posting's first appearance. This fact is robust to restricting attention

only to those postings that first appear in the first half of the panel, reducing the potential for censoring to account for short waves.[5] After that, hiring falls to 9% of the peak weekly rate, on average, and 34% among postings still on the board.

Second, waves across domains arrive successively. Language and transcription comes first and is largely finished before the others begin. Software engineering and data analysis follow. Demand then shifts toward professional services. Finance, law, medicine, and business operations all reach 50 percent of their hiring within a three-week span. The sciences sit between these groups and show the least wave-like profile: life, physical, and social science peaks at 491 hires per day on August 9 yet is still running at 27.7 percent of that at the panel's end.

These wave patterns are robust to alternative constructions and classifications. Appendix Figure 10 shows that the waves are present in raw daily hires without the 7-day smoothing, while Figure 11 shows smoother but similar waves when we convert hires into the stock of experts at work using posting-level duration assumptions. Figure 9 shows that the pattern also persists under the SOC classification, even though these broader occupation groups can combine distinct types of expertise with different timing, such as Office and Administrative Support combining parts of data analysis and business operations. We note an important caveat to estimating work duration: after matching, a working relationship can continue indefinitely off-platform, producing new training data without showing up as a new hire in our panel.

Obs. 2: Average wages start above the US full-time equivalent in traditional labor markets, in the same occupation.

Expertise-as-training-data is exchanged in a global marketplace, but the same experts can also supply their labor in traditional labor markets. We therefore compare posted wages on the platform with wages for the same occupations in the US labor market.

To construct this comparison, we map each job posting to a detailed (6-digit) SOC occupation using its title and description and match it to wages from the BLS Occupational Employment and Wage Statistics (OEWS). We use OEWS wage data for May 2025 and express both sides in September 13, 2026 dollars using the Employment Cost Index for wages and salaries of private-industry workers.[6]

Most listings for expertise-as-training-data post an hourly pay rate, with less than 10% offering contingent pay for completed tasks.[7] Among hourly postings, the hires-weighted average

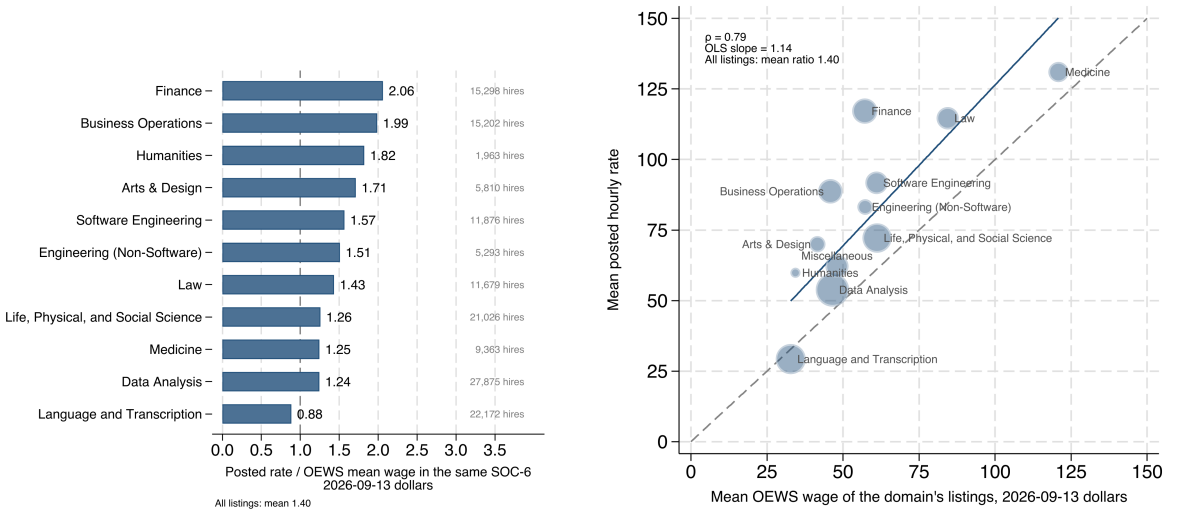
[5] These shares leave out the postings already on the board on the panel's first day, whose start we do not observe, and the postings whose first four weeks run past the end of the panel. Postings that first appear in the first half of the panel are observed for at least five months. The rates after the fourth week also leave out the postings whose first eight weeks run past the end of the panel.

[6] We use the not-seasonally-adjusted Employment Cost Index for wages and salaries of private-industry workers to update the May 2025 OEWS wage estimates. The latest available ECI observation is 2026Q2; subsequent index values are extrapolated at the annual growth rate observed between 2025Q2 and 2026Q2.

[7] Contingent pay becomes increasingly common over the panel, rising to nearly half of new hires in the latest period.

posted range is 28.1% of the midpoint, and 31.7% of hires face a single posted wage. We use the midpoint of the posted range in Figure 2, but relative wages remain higher on average using the wage floor instead.

Figure 2: Relative Wages by Expertise Domain



A. Mean pay ratio by domain: posted midpoint over the mean OEWS wage in the same narrow occupation (SOC-6), weighted by hires

B. Mean posted midpoint against the mean OEWS wage of the domain's listings (matched at SOC-6), weighted by hires

The hires-weighted average wage ratio is 1.40 times the US mean wage for the same narrow occupation. The premium appears in all but one domain: it is largest in Finance (2.06) and Business Operations (1.99), and smallest in Language and Transcription (0.88), which is also the earliest hiring wave in Figure 1, with 23,225 total hires. Posted rates also closely track the US wage structure across domains: domains that pay more in the US also pay more on the platform. The fitted relationship lies above the 45-degree equal-pay line and has a slope of 1.14, indicating that the dollar premium increases as the US wage of the occupation rises.

The result is mostly robust to using our alternative SOC classification. Appendix Figure 15A groups listings by SOC-2 major group rather than by the platform's domains.[8] Although the ordering of premiums changes across groups, the relationship between platform and US wages remains positive. However, this relationship is less than proportional (OLS slope of 0.93) under the SOC-6 detailed occupations (Figure 15B).

The premium remains when using the floor rather than the midpoint of each posted wage range. The mean ratio falls from 1.40 to 1.19, and the ranking of major groups remains similar,

[8]The average pay ratio coincides between the domain and the SOC-2 figures because we weight listings rather than the categories after aggregating: each listing's ratio counts by the listing's hires, and the average is taken over listings before they are grouped, so regrouping them by SOC-2 major group leaves the 1.40 of the main text unchanged.

although the premium is no longer as widespread. Sales and Related remains well above the US wage (1.90), followed by Business and Financial Operations (1.72), while Computer and Mathematical (0.99), Health Practitioners and Technical (0.99), and Arts, Design, Entertainment, Sports, and Media (0.82) fall below parity. The across-occupation relationship is also little changed ($\rho = +0.72$ under both the floor and midpoint specifications). Thus, even assigning each posting the bottom of its wage range, platform wages average about one fifth above the US mean for the same occupation.

The premium is not explained by the geographic composition of hiring. Although our benchmark is the US wage, only 24 percent of hires are on listings restricted to US workers, and US restrictions are not concentrated in the groups with the largest premiums (Figure 16). The three groups with the highest pay ratios—Sales and Related, Business and Financial Operations, and Educational Instruction and Library—restrict 16, 15, and 5 percent of hires to the US, respectively. By contrast, the two groups with the highest US-only shares, Management (67 percent) and Healthcare Practitioners (57 percent), have pay ratios of 1.66 and 1.18.

These comparisons nevertheless have important limitations. They concern posted cash compensation and therefore do not account for benefits associated with traditional employment, which could offset some or all of the observed wage difference. In addition, the OEWS mean pools all workers within an occupation, whereas the platform screens applicants for particular tasks, so worker composition may differ even within a 6-digit SOC occupation. However, Appendix C.2 shows that stated degree and experience requirements are lower on the platform than in the corresponding occupations, providing no evidence that the wage premium is driven by more stringent observable credential requirements.

Obs. 3: Early hiring waves experienced wage declines within the domain over time.

We next examine how the price of expertise evolves over time. A simple average of posted wages moves with the composition of listings, not only with the rates attached to them. For example, if the platform shifts from recruiting physicians to recruiting medical transcriptionists, the average posted wage within the same domain might fall even when no individual listing has changed its rate. We therefore construct a matched-listing price index that follows the same listings over time.

The index follows the design of the BLS Employment Cost Index (ECI). Within each of the platform's twelve expertise domains, we compare the posted hourly-equivalent rates of listings observed on consecutive days, averaging their log rate changes. We then aggregate the domains by their wage bills over the preceding 120 days—each domain's hires in that window, valued at the rate its listing posted on the day of the hire—as the ECI aggregates its industry–occupation cells by base-period wage bills. Because every weight uses only hires made before the day in

question, the index is computable in real time and does not revise as later data arrive.

Our index departs from the ECI in three ways. First, our weights roll over a trailing window rather than being fixed at a base period. Fixed weights are appropriate when the composition of employment moves slowly, but Observation 1 shows that hiring in this market arrives in successive waves, so weights fixed at the start of the panel would be dominated by the domains hiring in November and would assign almost no weight to those hiring in the summer. A window that trails the current date, rather than expanding to cover all history, keeps the weights focused on where hiring is currently concentrated.[9] Second, within a domain we use unweighted averages of log changes (Jevons) rather than taking the ratio of average wages (Dutot, the ECI's within-cell ratio without its sample weights), which limits the influence of individual large changes and follows standard practice for elementary aggregates in price statistics where the number of observations is small. Third, our prices are posted rates rather than paid wages, drawn from a census of one platform. Appendix D gives the formulas and sets out the comparison with the ECI in full.

We find that the price of expertise falls over our sample, as shown in Figure 3. In the aggregate, the matched-listing index declines by 3.2 percent between November 11, 2025 and September 12, 2026. The general decline is especially notable because posted wages for continuing listings are sticky, adjusting as infrequent discrete changes rather than continuously. The decline is concentrated in Medicine, where matched-listing wages fall by roughly 28 percent, followed by Life, Physical, and Social Science and Data Analysis, at about 5 and 4 percent. Several other domains move little in either direction—Finance and Humanities are flat or slightly up, while Software Engineering, Business Operations, Language and Transcription, and Arts & Design fall by between 1 and 3 percent—and Law and non-software Engineering rise by 8 and 5 percent at the end of our sample.

[9] Hires made before November 11, 2025 are known only through each posting's trailing counter, which covers the 30 days preceding the panel's first day. The weights therefore draw on a full 120 days only from February 9, 2026 onward; before that date the trailing and expanding windows coincide.

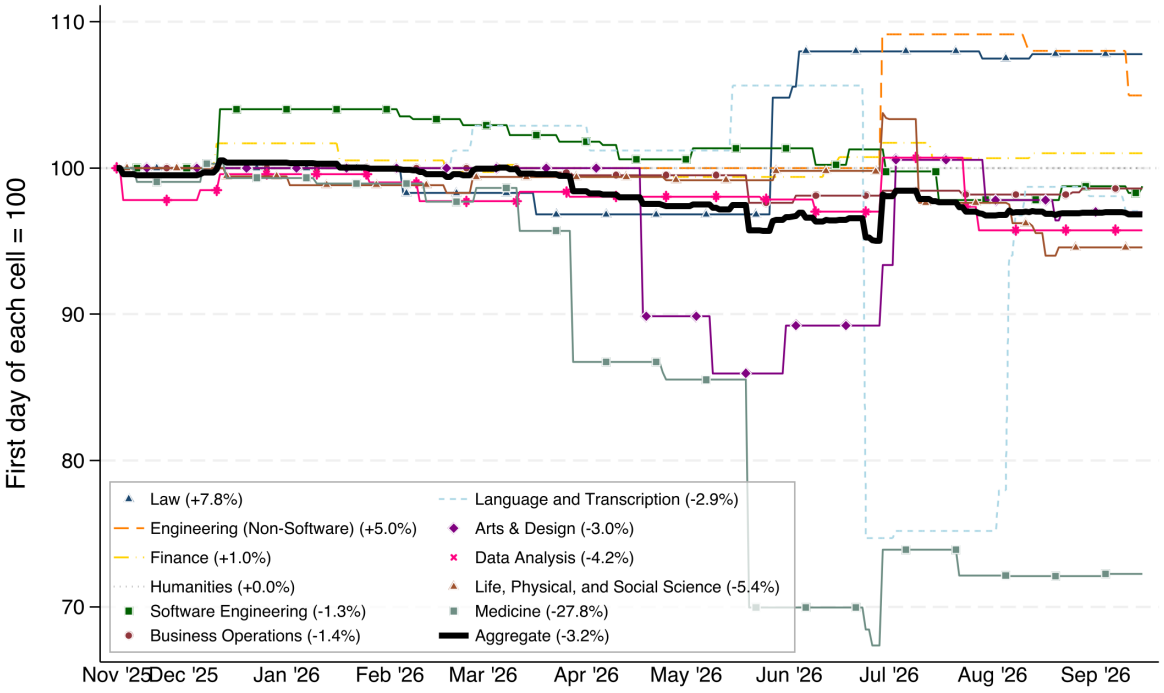


Figure 3: **Matched-listing wage indices by expertise domain.** The figure reports matched-listing wage indices separately by expertise domain, together with the platform-wide weighted average. Each index follows continuing listings over time, so changes reflect revisions to posted rates rather than the entry or exit of listings. The plotted domains are the eleven with at least 1,000 hires, the sample of Figure 1. The aggregate weights each domain's daily change by its share of the wage bill of the hires made in the previous 120 days, Eq. (3).

Table 1 reports the aggregate under alternative weighting windows and within-domain formulas. Two things are worth noting. First, nearly every specification we examine yields a decline, though the magnitude varies with the weights window: 1.8 percent at 60 days, 2.8 at 90, 3.2 at 120, 3.3 at 150, and 3.3 at 180 for the Jevons index. Longer windows give larger declines, and the series flattens beyond four months, which is why we chose the 120-day window as our benchmark. Second, the within-domain formula matters more than the weights. Under the Dutot index, which divides the sum of the current day's rates by the sum of the previous day's and so weights each listing by its posted rate, the aggregate falls 5.8 percent, and 2.3 percent excluding Medicine. The two formulas are computed from the same continuing listings and differ only in how those listings' rate changes are averaged. We report the Jevons geometric average as our benchmark because our domains are far broader than the ECI's industry–occupation cells and we have no quantity weight for an individual listing, so weighting by the posted rate would let a few high-paying listings drive a domain's measured change.

Wage adjustment may also occur through the rates attached to newly created listings. This is a margin that no matched-job index captures, including the ECI, because a job must appear in

Table 1: Matched-listing wage index under alternative weights and formulas

	Jevons		Dutot	
Weighting window	All domains	Ex. Medicine	All domains	Ex. Medicine
60 days	−1.8	+0.4	−4.0	−1.0
90 days	−2.8	−0.3	−5.5	−2.1
120 days	−3.2	−0.6	−5.8	−2.3
150 days	−3.3	−0.7	−5.9	−2.3
180 days	−3.3	−0.7	−5.8	−2.2

Notes: Percent change in the matched-listing wage index between November 11, 2025 and September 12, 2026. Every entry follows the same continuing listings, weighting each domain by the wage bill of its hires in the trailing window. Jevons averages log rate changes within a domain; Dutot divides the sum of the current day's rates by the sum of the previous day's, the unweighted version of the ratio the ECI uses within its cells. The 120-day Jevons entry, −3.2, is the specification reported in the text. The ex-Medicine columns remove Medicine's listings from the weights and from the aggregate. Weighting domains by hires alone, without valuing them at posted rates, gives declines of 0.2 to 2.2 percent under Jevons and 1.9 to 4.7 under Dutot across the same windows. Weights fixed over the panel's opening window, which cannot be computed in real time, give 3.5 to 7.4 percent. Appendix D reports every version with its figures.

two consecutive periods to enter the comparison. In Appendix Figure 8, we construct an index based exclusively on the initial hourly-equivalent wages posted by newly appearing listings. This index is considerably more volatile than the matched-listing index, suggesting that new listings may provide an additional margin through which compensation adjusts. However, comparisons across new listings do not hold the underlying expertise fixed. Listings entering at different points in time may differ in specialty, qualifications, seniority, task requirements, or other characteristics that we do not observe. We therefore treat the new-listing evidence as suggestive of an additional adjustment margin rather than as a price index for fixed-quality expertise.

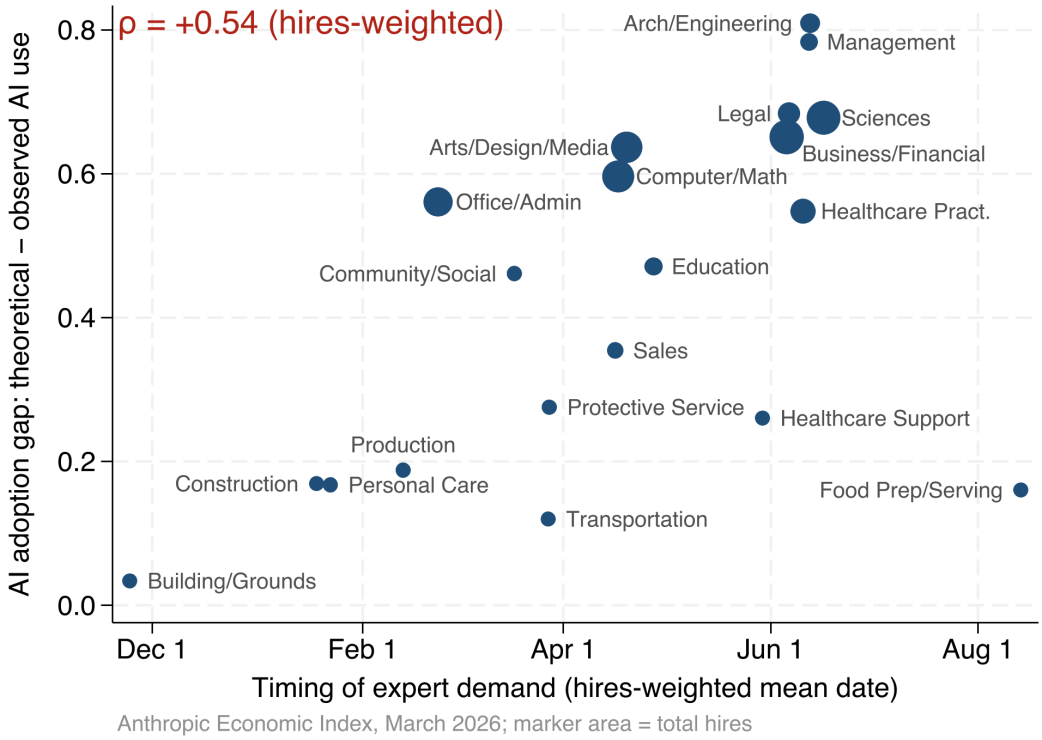
Obs. 4: The timing of hiring predicts the AI adoption gap.

The AI adoption gap, constructed by Massenkoff and McCrory (2026) and building on Eloundou et al. (2023), measures the difference between theoretical AI use and observed AI use. Figure 4 plots the timing of each group's hiring wave (the hires-weighted mean date) against its AI adoption gap, as measured in March 2026. Wave timing, weighting each major group by its hires, and the March 2026 AI adoption gap are positively correlated ($\rho = +0.54$). Observed and theoretical AI use are negatively correlated with wave timing ($\rho = -0.60$ and $\rho = -0.21$, respectively) as shown in Figure 5. The most recent waves may have targeted areas where AI's usefulness lagged what the technology could feasibly support, and the early waves may have contributed to the higher rates of AI use and applicability. However, what we observe is just a correlation and does not imply causation.

The total size of the marketplace, measured both in hires and estimated total spend, corre-

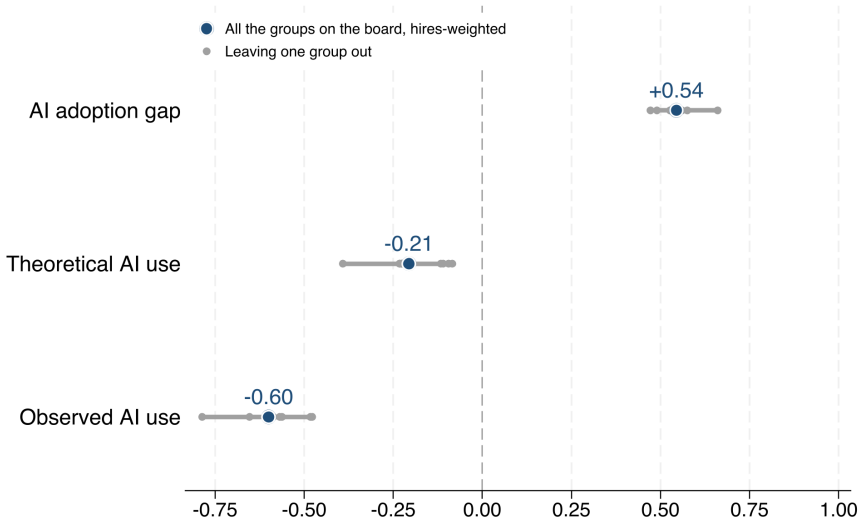
lates positively with AI's overall potential for automation, as reported in Appendix Figure 20. The result is also robust to restricting to the eleven SOC-2 groups with at least 1,000 hires over the panel, the selection used elsewhere in the paper, where the hires-weighted correlation is effectively unchanged (Figure 21).

Figure 4: Timing of expert hiring and the AI adoption gap



Notes: Each point is one of the twenty SOC 2-digit major groups that appear on the board. The horizontal axis is the timing of the occupation group's hiring through the platform: the hires-weighted mean date over November 11, 2025 to September 12, 2026, with daily hires recovered as in Appendix A. The vertical axis is the group's AI adoption gap: theoretical minus observed AI use, employment-weighted (Anthropic Economic Index, March 2026). Marker area scales with the group's total hires. The ρ weights each group by that same quantity, so a group's influence on the statistic is what its marker shows. Every one of the eleven groups with at least 1,000 hires is still hiring at the September 12 end of the panel — each places between 11 and 41 percent of its hires in the final 28 days — so their mean dates are right-censored and their true dates are later than shown.

Figure 5: Correlation of hiring-wave timing with AI-use measures



Notes: Correlation between the timing of each group's hiring wave (the hires-weighted mean date of the platform's hiring, November 11, 2025 to September 12, 2026, with daily hires recovered from the trailing counter as in Appendix A) and three occupation-group AI-use measures, across the twenty SOC 2-digit major groups that appear on the board, with each correlation weighted by the group's hires. All three measures are employment-weighted aggregates over each group's occupations from the Anthropic Economic Index release of March 5, 2026: observed AI use from Anthropic usage logs, theoretical AI use from the human-rated full-exposure series of Eloundou et al. (2023), and the AI adoption gap, their difference. Large dots use all twenty groups; small dots re-compute each correlation leaving out one group at a time, and the bar spans the resulting min–max range. Timing correlates +0.54 with the adoption gap and stays positive in every leave-one-out sample (+0.47 to +0.66). The distance between theoretical AI use in a work domain and observed use is the AI adoption gap. We separately show the correlation with these components: the timing of hiring waves is negatively correlated with observed use (−0.60) and, more weakly, with theoretical use taken on its own (−0.21). Every group with at least 1,000 hires is still hiring at the September 12 end of the panel, so the mean dates are right-censored.

Interpreting the observations

We interpret Observations 1–4 through a simple dynamic model with two domains of expertise, A and B.

Demand for expertise. A monopsonist buyer of expertise acquires training data from a unit mass of identical experts in each domain. The stocks $Q_t^A, Q_t^B \geq 0$ generate a flow benefit $U(Q_t^A, Q_t^B)$. This benefit reflects both the mapping from training data to model capabilities, including transfer learning across domains, and downstream demand for those capabilities.

Domain A is foundational: its data is valuable on its own. Domain B is specialized: its data pays off only after a model has absorbed enough of domain A. For instance, language and law fit this relation, since legal reasoning presupposes fluent language—indeed, we see in the data that the platform hires language experts months before legal experts; our model offers a simple rationalization.

Supply of expertise. At each date, the firm posts a wage w_t^i per unit of data. An expert in domain $i \in \{A, B\}$ earns an outside wage $\bar{w}_i \geq 0$ per unit of effort elsewhere, chooses effort $q_t^i \geq 0$ for the firm, and receives

$$\underbrace{(w_t^i - \bar{w}_i)q_t^i}_{\substack{\text{Wage net of} \\ \text{outside option}}} - \underbrace{c(q_t^i)}_{\substack{\text{Cost of} \\ \text{supplying} \\ \text{expertise}}}.$$

The outside wage is the opportunity cost of time; the cost c captures the disutility of supplying expertise. With strictly convex costs, the supply at time t satisfies $w_t^i = \bar{w}_i + c'(q_t^i)$ and is zero whenever the posted wage w_t^i is weakly below the reservation wage. Workers choose effort separately at each date: payoffs are linear in earnings, there are no income effects and current effort does not affect future opportunities.

The extraction problem. The firm chooses how quickly to extract each kind of expertise i.e., chooses flows $(q_t^A)_t$ and $(q_t^B)_t$. Equivalently, it does so by implementing positive rates with wages $w_t^i = \bar{w}_i + c'(q_t^i)$. Its wage bill in domain i is therefore $q_t^i\big[\bar{w}_i + c'(q_t^i)\big]$. At discount rate $r > 0$, the firm solves

$$\begin{aligned} \max_{\{q_t^A, q_t^B\}_{t\geq 0}} \quad & \int_0^\infty e^{-rt}\left[U(Q_t^A, Q_t^B) - \sum_{i=A,B} q_t^i\big[\bar{w}_i + c'(q_t^i)\big]\right] dt \\ \text{subject to} \quad & \dot{Q}_t^i = q_t^i \\ & q_t^i \geq 0 \\ & Q_0^i = 0. \end{aligned} \tag{P}$$

Problem (P) is fairly unwieldy without more structure on the demand (U) and supply (c) of expertise. We now impose more structure.

Assumption 1 (Diminishing returns and complementarity)**.** The benefit takes the form

$$U(Q^A, Q^B) = \alpha Q^A + \beta Q^B + \gamma Q^A Q^B - \frac{\delta}{2}\big[(Q^A)^2 + (Q^B)^2\big],$$

where $\beta \geq 0$ and $\delta > \gamma > 0$. This implies that domain-B data has a nonnegative initial standalone benefit, U is strictly concave, and domain-A data raise the marginal value of domain-B data.

Assumption 2 (Upward-sloping supply and convex procurement costs)**.** The cost of supplying expertise is thrice continuously differentiable on $[0, \infty)$, with $c'(0) > 0$, and the firm's wage bill

$qc'(q)$ is uniformly strictly convex.[10]

Assumption 3. Write $\hat{\alpha} = \alpha - r\bar{w}_A$ and $\hat{\beta} = \beta - r\bar{w}_B$ for the benefits net of the outside-wage flow costs. Suppose:

(i) **Initial advantage of domain A.** The net standalone benefits satisfy

$$\hat{\alpha} > rc'(0) > \hat{\beta}.$$

Net of its outside wage, domain A is initially worth acquiring; domain B is not worthwhile on its own.

(ii) **Eventual entry of domain B.** Complementarity satisfies

$$\gamma\big[\hat{\alpha} - rc'(0)\big] > \delta\big[rc'(0) - \hat{\beta}\big].$$

Accumulating domain-A data eventually makes acquiring domain-B data worthwhile.

(iii) **Bounded gains from complementarity.** Let $L > 0$ solve $c'(L) + Lc''(L) = \hat{\alpha}/r$. Assume

$$\frac{\gamma L}{r} < rc'(0) - \hat{\beta}.$$

This limits the strength of complementarity γ relative to domain B's initial shortfall in value (recall $rc'(0) > \hat{\beta}$).

We have the following simple result on the optimal extraction path.

Proposition 1 (Successive waves of expertise extraction)**.** *Under Assumptions 1–3, problem* (P) *has a unique optimal extraction path a.e., with a continuous representative satisfying:*

(i) ***Successive waves.*** *Domain-A extraction is positive and strictly decreasing. There exist dates $0 < \tau < t_{\text{peak}} < \infty$ such that domain-B extraction is zero on $[0, \tau]$, strictly increases on (τ, t_{peak}), and strictly decreases thereafter. Both rates converge to zero.*

(ii) ***Wage dynamics.*** *Active wages satisfy $w_t^i = \bar{w}_i + c'(q_t^i) > \bar{w}_i + c'(0)$. Domain-A wages decline throughout; domain-B wages rise and then decline, peaking at t_{peak}. Active wages converge to the reservation wage $\bar{w}_i + c'(0)$.*

(iii) ***Stock and wage ordering.*** *At each time $t > 0$, the aggregate stock of expertise satisfies $Q_t^A > Q_t^B$. Domain-B wages exceed domain-A wages at every $t > \tau$ if and only if*

$$\bar{w}_B - \bar{w}_A \geq c'(q_\tau^A) - c'(0).$$

[10] This means that there is a constant $m > 0$ such that $[qc'(q)]'' = 2c''(q) + qc'''(q) \geq m$ for every $q \geq 0$. It also implies $c''(q) \geq m/2 > 0$: for $q > 0$, integrating gives $q^2 c''(q) = \int_0^q s[2c''(s) + sc'''(s)]\, ds \geq mq^2/2$, and the bound at zero follows by continuity.

If $\bar{w}_B \leq \bar{w}_A$, domain-A wages exceed domain-B wages at every $t > \tau$. In the remaining case, domain-B wages are initially lower than that of domain-A but higher eventually.

Proposition 1 offers a mechanism for several patterns in Observations 1–4. First, diminishing returns reduce demand for additional expertise within a domain, while complementarity makes specialized expertise worth acquiring later, generating overlapping waves of expert effort. This is consistent with the successive waves of hiring across domains documented by Observation 1. Indeed, Table 2 offers some suggestive evidence that expertise in more 'foundational domains' were extracted before more 'specialized domains'. Second, the combination of (i) an upward-sloping supply curve of expertise within each period; (ii) the need to pay at least workers' outside option; and (iii) diminishing returns to additional units of expertise generate wages that are initially elevated, but gradually decline consistent with Observations 2-3. Finally, Proposition 1 supplies a potential mechanism for Observation 4 that shows occupations with later hiring waves tend to have larger gaps between potential and observed use. In particular, cross-domain complementarity can explain why a domain with a large adoption gap attracts expertise acquisition later: when specialized capabilities (e.g., domain-B) depend on foundations that are still being developed, their current use can remain low even though their eventual potential is high. Building those foundations (by accumulating domain-A expertise) raises the return to specialized expertise, thereby prompting its subsequent acquisition. Thus, dependence on foundational capabilities can therefore generate both a large current adoption gap and a later hiring wave.

Table 2: Candidate pairs of domains

$A \to B$	Why domain-A data might help domain B	Half-of-hires dates ($A \to B$)
Language → law	Legal reasoning is done in text	17 Dec → 16 Jun
Data analysis → finance	Financial modeling applies quantitative analysis	27 Mar → 20 Jun
Software engineering → data analysis	Analysis runs through code	18 Mar → 27 Mar (only 9 days apart)
Language → humanities	Humanities scholarship is textual	17 Dec → 7 May (humanities has only 1,963 hires)
Data analysis → business operations	Operations work relies on analysis	27 Mar → 3 Jul
Sciences → medicine	Clinical reasoning builds on biology and chemistry	25 Jun → 23 Jun (half-of-hires dates reversed)

Notes: For each pair, the hires-weighted mean hiring dates (the row order of the hiring-wave figure for Observation 1) put domain A first. The last column reports the dates on which each domain reaches half of its panel hires, read from the labels of that figure.

Our results are connected to the idea of transfer learning. One interpretation of the complementarity $\gamma > 0$ in Assumption 1 is positive transfer: capability built from domain-A data raises

the return to domain-B data.[11] Although frontier labs are quite secretive about the composition and ordering of training data, we know that open-weight models generally build broad capability first and raises the weight on specialized data only late in training.[12] According to such (albeit dated) reports, the ordering is chosen because specialized data are more productive once general capability is in place. For instance, AceReason-Nemotron trains on math-only prompts before code-only prompts and finds that "math-only RL not only significantly enhances the performance of strong distilled models on math benchmarks ... but also code reasoning tasks" [9].

Figure 6 illustrates optimal extraction paths for domains A (red) and B (blue) as complementarity γ varies.[13] Figure 7 shows extraction rates in levels and wages when domain B's outside wage is much higher than domain A's.[14]

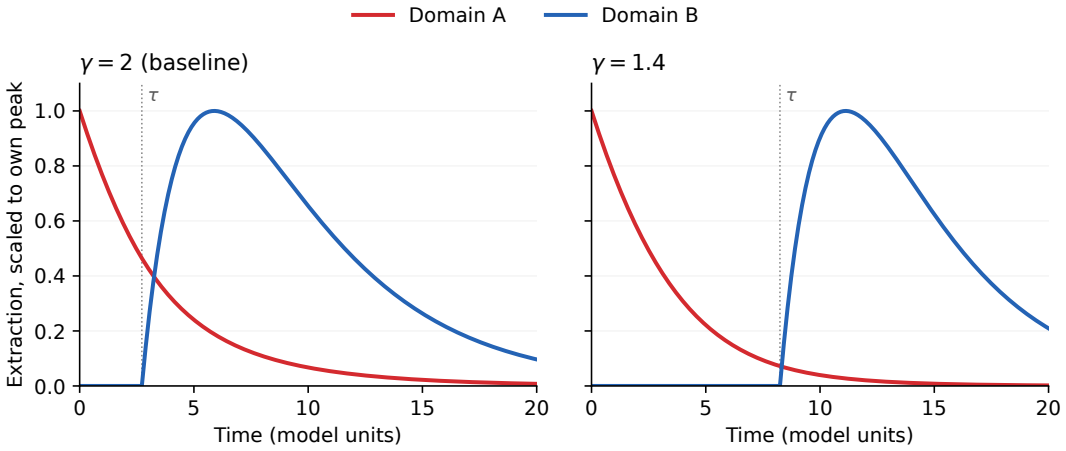


Figure 6: Extraction waves as complementarity weakens

Notes: Optimal extraction rates, each scaled to its own peak.

[11]Note here that expertise is deliberately and strategically extracted by a firm. By contrast, [5] studies an economy in which expertise is accumulated endogenously in equilibrium as a by-product of production.

[12]SmolLM3 raises the share of code and math in its pretraining mix from 15 to 25 to 37 percent across three stages [6]; OLMo 2 devotes a final 5–10 percent of compute to curated web, academic, and synthetic math data [7]; Qwen3 follows an initial general stage of over 30 trillion tokens with about 5 trillion tokens weighted toward STEM, coding, and reasoning [10]. [8] survey this practice.

[13]Parameters: $r = 1$, $\alpha = 4$, $\beta = 0$, $\delta = 4$, $\bar{w}_A = \bar{w}_B = 0$, and $c(q) = q + 2q^2 + q^3$, with $\gamma \in \{2, 1.4\}$. Assumptions 1–3 hold in both panels. Each extraction rate is scaled to its own peak.

[14]Parameters: $r = 1$, $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta) = (15, 0, 3.9, 4)$, $(\bar{w}_A, \bar{w}_B) = (1, 7)$, $c(q) = q + 2q^2$; Assumptions 1–3 hold. Domain B enters at $\tau \approx 2.0$, when domain-A wages have fallen from 6.8 to 4.4, and pays more than domain A at every date thereafter: the condition in part (iii) of Proposition 1 holds with $c'(q_\tau^A) - c'(0) \approx 2.4 < 6 = \bar{w}_B - \bar{w}_A$.

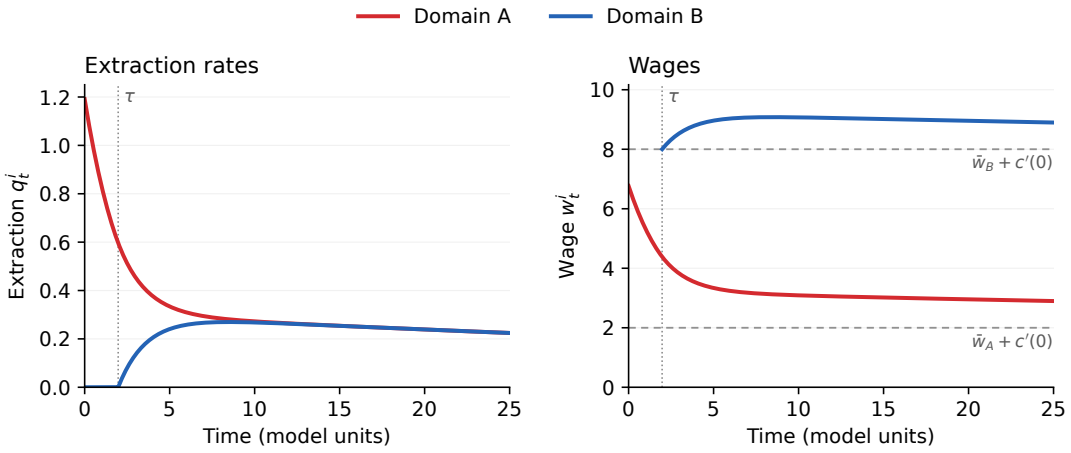


Figure 7: Extraction and wages with a high outside wage in domain B

Conclusion

The market for human expertise used to train AI can differ from a traditional labor market in an important way: expertise purchased today may reduce the value of purchasing more of the same expertise tomorrow. We find patterns consistent with this hypothesis. Experts are initially hired at high posted wages, but hiring in many domains arrives in concentrated waves and then declines, while wages for continuing listings also fall. Demand then shifts across domains, with later waves concentrated in occupations with larger gaps between potential and observed AI use.

These patterns of data acquisition are jointly explained with a simple model of data accumulation. A buyer accumulates stocks of expertise in a foundational and a specialized domain, with diminishing returns to each stock, complementarity between the two, and an upward-sloping supply of expert effort. Diminishing returns generate the decline within a domain: each unit acquired lowers the value of the next, so hiring falls, and pay falls with it as the buyer moves down the supply curve. Upward-sloping supply generates the premium: while a domain is being built, the buyer pays above experts' reservation wage to obtain the data sooner, and pay returns toward that level as the wave subsides. Complementarity generates successive waves: specialized expertise is not worth buying until enough foundational data has accumulated, so it enters later in a wave of its own.

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Appendix

A Daily hires from the trailing counter

Each posting displays a counter of the form "N hired this month." The counter is a rolling 31-day sum: on day t it shows $c_t = \sum_{s=t-30}^{t} h_s$, where h_s is the number of hires the posting made on day s. Its daily change is therefore

$$c_t - c_{t-1} \;=\; h_t - h_{t-31},$$

the current day's hires minus the hires that fall out of the window. We recover the daily series by inverting this identity, $h_t = (c_t - c_{t-1}) + h_{t-31}$, and bound each h_t between 0 and c_t so that measurement noise cannot produce negative hires or more hires than the counter displays. When a posting skips a day on the board, we record no hires that day and let its counter fall by the hires leaving the window, so a multi-day change is attributed to the day the posting reappears.

The recursion requires starting values, which depend on when a posting first appears. For postings that enter during our panel, we treat the first observed date as the posting's start date. The counter shown on that first day is therefore assigned to hires on that day. For the next 30 days, no hires can yet be falling out of the 31-day window, so daily hires are identified directly by changes in the counter. Beginning on day 31, we apply the recursion above, adding back the hires from 31 days earlier.

Postings that are captured on the first day of the panel require a separate initialization. There are 288 such postings, representing 12 percent of postings, with day-one counters totaling 7,419 hires, or 3.5 percent of all hires. Because these counters summarize hiring over the preceding 31 days, we cannot date those hires individually. We assume that each posting's initial counter accrued evenly over that 31-day window. Thus, one thirty-first of the initial counter is assigned to the first panel day, while the remaining shares are treated as pre-panel hires. These imputed pre-panel values provide the initial lagged hires needed to start the recursion. Because subsequently recovered hires themselves enter the add-back term 31 days later, the initialization can affect the estimated daily series beyond the first month and, in principle, throughout the panel.

B Hiring Waves Across Classifications

Regardless of how we classify hiring and work, our evidence suggests that the nature of expertise-as-training-data appears as waves.

Figure 9 redraws Figure 1 with hiring classified by SOC 2-digit major group (the title-to-occupation mapping of the Data Description) instead of the platform's own domain tags. The waves survive the reclassification, and two corresponding categories peak on the same days: Healthcare Practitioners and Medicine on August 24, and Computer and Mathematical

and Software Engineering on February 22. Architecture and Engineering and its counterpart Engineering (non-software) are also closely aligned, peaking five days apart.

Figure 10 instead removes the 7-day moving average from the domain figure. The rises, peaks, and declines are in the raw daily series. Figure 11 recasts the flow of new hires as the stock of experts at work under the lengths the postings state; Section C.1 explains how those durations are calculated, and assumptions made when the listing does not include any details about the length. Across these alterative visualizations of the hiring and work carried out, successive waves across domains appear.

C Expertise-As-Training-Data Contracts

C.1 Work Duration

The board's structured fields do not include the length of engagement. Hence, we have a large language model read the full description of each of the 2,348 postings and report what the posting says about the engagement: how long the work lasts and how many hours a week it takes.

Panel A of Table 4 reports the results of this process. Most postings do not include an end date. The 491 postings that fix an end carry 21.6 percent of hires, and the mean length they state, weighted by hires, is 23 days. For Figure 11, we assert that postings without a specified end date last for the hires-weighted mean duration of those that so assert an end date; Figure 12 keeps only the postings that state an end, so no length is assumed.

Panel B repeats the exercise for work intensity: how many hours a week the work requires. Over half of the postings include details about the number of hours per week, 1,273 listings carrying 52.7 percent of hires. The median stated intensity is 20 hours a week, weighted by hires. For our main compensation estimate, we use each listing's median weekly hours reported in the platform's structured field, assuming 40 hours when the field is missing and one-week engagements for hourly jobs. Using description-derived hours and fallback rules in Panel B instead reduces estimated compensation from approximately $540 million to $437 million.

Figure 11 turns the stated lengths into a stock: each dated hire occupies the days of its posting's engagement, and the curve counts the experts at work each day (the weekly hours matter only when hourly rates are converted into pay). The hiring waves of Figure 1 reappear as waves of experts at work.

C.2 Degree and Experience Requirements

We map job descriptions to their detailed O*NET-SOC classifications. This allows us to compare the degree and experience requirements observed among workers in these narrow SOC 6-digit occupations. Overall, we find that the required degrees and years of experience are lower in the listings for expertise-as-training-data. Figures 13 and 14 describe education and experience

requirements by SOC-2 major group. Figure 13, panel A, reports the share of hires associated with listings stating no degree requirement; degrees in progress count as requirements, while merely preferred degrees do not. Panel B compares stated education requirements, expressed in years of schooling, with the median requirement reported in O*NET for the listing's SOC-6 occupation.[15] Figure 14 makes the corresponding comparison for related work experience: panel A assigns zero years to listings stating no requirement, while panel B restricts the comparison to listings requiring at least one year. In the gap panels, listing-level differences are averaged within each group using hires as weights; negative values indicate lower requirements than the occupational benchmark. The figures distinguish the absence of an explicit credential requirement from the level required when one is stated.

On average, 60% of hires come from listings without a stated degree requirement, and a listing asks for 1.2 fewer years of experience than the median incumbent of its occupation. What's driving this, however, is the absence of degree and experience requirements in the marketplace for human expertise-as-training-data. Among the listings that do state an experience requirement (panel B of Figure 14), the gap reverses, with listings asking for 1.1 more years of experience. One potential explanation for this is that the screening for expertise through AI interviews on the platform allows the platform to screen for expertise best matched for the specific task.

C.3 Wage Rates

Using the mapping between job postings and detailed occupations (SOC-6), we compare wages and requirements in this marketplace with occupational benchmarks from conventional labor markets: May 2025 OEWS data for wages and O*NET data for education and experience requirements. For the wage comparison, we retain postings with a consistent time-based pay format and use each posting's last observed rate. Because posted rates and OEWS wages are observed at different dates, we adjust both from their respective observation quarters to September 13, 2026 using the Employment Cost Index for wages and salaries of private-industry workers.[16]

On average, the posted midpoint is 1.4 times the US mean wage for the same occupation, despite being a global marketplace for talent. Figure 15 reports the construction behind that number. Figure 15A shows the ratio by SOC-2 major group: each listing's midpoint over the OEWS mean wage of its own SOC-6 occupation, averaged within the group with hires as weights, for the ten SOC-2 major groups with at least 1,000 hires in the eligible wage sample. Figure 15B shows the same comparison in levels, one point per SOC-6 occupation: the occu-

[15] We benchmark against the median rather than the mean answer because each SOC-6 occupation's distribution comes from a limited number of surveyed incumbents: with few respondents the mean is noisy, while the median is more stable.

[16] Daily, weekly, monthly, and yearly posted rates are converted to hourly equivalents using eight hours per day, 40 hours per week, and 2,080 hours per year (2,080/12 per month); OEWS occupations reporting only annual pay are converted using 2,080 hours. We use the not-seasonally-adjusted index. The available ECI series ends in 2026Q2; subsequent values are extrapolated using its growth over the preceding four quarters.

pation's hire-weighted mean posted midpoint against its OEWS mean wage. For robustness, Figure 17 replaces means with medians throughout; in other words, each listing's midpoint over the OEWS *median* wage of its occupation, summarized by hire-weighted medians. Figure 18 repeats the exercise at the floor of the posted range; Figure 19 drops the hire weights, giving every listing an equal vote. Figure 2 of the main text keeps the SOC-6 match but aggregates by the platform's domains rather than by SOC-2: each domain's mean posted rate is plotted against the mean OEWS wage of its listings, both sides averaged over the same listings and weighted by hires within each domain. Figure 16 shows the hire-weighted share of listings restricted to the US in each SOC-2 group, with the rows in the order of Figure 15A: the groups with the highest pay ratios show low US-only shares, so the premium is not explained by listings that require US-based workers.

D Matched-listing wage indices

D.1 Notation

Let j index the listings that post a time rate in a single format over their life, i the twelve expertise domains, and t days, with d_0 the panel's first day, November 11, 2025. Write $p_{j,t}$ for the posted hourly-equivalent rate of listing j on day t—the midpoint of the posted range, with daily, weekly, monthly and yearly rates converted at eight hours per day, 40 per week, 2,080/12 per month and 2,080 per year—and $n_{j,s}$ for the hires listing j made on day s, recovered from the board's trailing counter as in Appendix A. Let $S_{t,i}$ be the set of *matched* listings in domain i on day t: those posting a rate on both day $t-1$ and day t.

D.2 Change within a domain

The index compares matched listings only, so that a domain's measured change reflects revisions to posted rates rather than the entry or exit of listings. Writing $M_{t,i}$ for domain i's cumulative change since d_0, with $M_{d_0,i} = 1$, the daily change is the unweighted mean of the log rate changes of the domain's matched listings:

$$\ln \frac{M_{t,i}}{M_{t-1,i}} = \frac{1}{|S_{t,i}|} \sum_{j \in S_{t,i}} \ln \frac{p_{j,t}}{p_{j,t-1}}. \tag{1}$$

This is the Jevons formula, the unweighted geometric mean of the price relatives. The alternative we report in Table 1 is Dutot, the ratio of the unweighted mean rates:

$$\frac{M_{t,i}}{M_{t-1,i}} = \frac{\sum_{j \in S_{t,i}} p_{j,t}}{\sum_{j \in S_{t,i}} p_{j,t-1}}. \tag{2}$$

Equation (2) can be written as $\sum_j \sigma_j \, p_{j,t}/p_{j,t-1}$ with $\sigma_j = p_{j,t-1}/\sum_k p_{k,t-1}$, so it weights each listing's change by its own posted rate while (1) weights every listing equally. The two therefore diverge when the listings whose rates move are not typical of their domain's pay level. A domain with no matched listings on day t takes the same mean or ratio over all matched listings on the board that day. A day without data inside a listing's life repeats its last rate and so counts as zero change.

D.3 Weights across domains

Each domain is weighted by the wage bill of its recent hires: the hires its listings made over the preceding 120 days, each valued at the rate its listing posted on the day of the hire,

$$H_{t,i} \;=\; \sum_{j \in i} \; \sum_{s=t-120}^{t-1} n_{j,s} \, p_{j,s}, \qquad w_{t,i} \;=\; \frac{H_{t,i}}{\sum_k H_{t,k}}. \tag{3}$$

Hires made before d_0 are known only in aggregate, as the part of each listing's first-day counter that Appendix A places before the panel (30/31 of it); we spread them evenly over the 30 days preceding d_0 and value them at the listing's rate on that day. The window is therefore full only from February 9, 2026 onward. Because $H_{t,i}$ uses hires made strictly before day t, every weight is known when the day's change is computed, and no past value of the index changes when later hiring is observed.

D.4 Aggregation

Because the weights move every day, they apply to each domain's daily change rather than to its cumulative change:

$$I_t \;=\; I_{t-1} \times \sum_i w_{t,i} \, \frac{M_{t,i}}{M_{t-1,i}}, \qquad I_{d_0} = 100. \tag{4}$$

D.5 Comparison with the Employment Cost Index

Table 3 sets the two constructions side by side, in the order of the three departures described in the text.

(i) Weights. The ECI's cell weight is $W_{0,i} = \bar{Y}_{0,i} E_i$, the cell's base-period average wage times its employment, with E_i taken from the OEWS and held fixed until the next reweighting. Ours is the wage bill of recent hires, Eq. (3), which moves every day. The two also enter the aggregate differently. The ECI applies its fixed weights to cumulative changes, $I_t = 100 \times \sum_i \omega_i M_{t,i}$ with $\omega_i = W_{0,i}/\sum_k W_{0,k}$. Ours apply to daily changes, Eq. (4), since moving weights applied to cumulative changes would shift the aggregate even on days when no listing revised its rate.

Table 3: The wage index and the Employment Cost Index

	This paper	BLS Employment Cost Index
(i) Weights across cells		
Weight on a cell	Wage bill of the hires in the previous 120 days, Eq. (3)	Employment times average wage in a fixed base period
Source and vintage	Hires already observed, updated daily	OEWS employment, updated about every ten years
Applied to	Daily changes, Eq. (4)	Cumulative changes
(ii) Formula within a cell		
Formula	Mean of log changes, Eq. (1)	Ratio of average wages, Eq. (5)
Weight on a job	Equal	Sample weight, summing to cell employment
(iii) Prices and sample		
Price	Posted rate, hourly terms, midpoint of the range	Wage paid in the job
Observations	Census of one job board	Probability sample of establishments
Cells	12 expertise domains	765 industry–occupation cells
Frequency	Daily, matched on consecutive days	Quarterly, matched on consecutive quarters

(ii) Formula. The ECI's within-cell ratio is

$$R_{t,i} \;=\; \frac{\sum_q \varpi_q \, Y_{q,t}}{\sum_q \varpi_q \, Y_{q,t-1}}, \tag{5}$$

where $Y_{q,t}$ is the average hourly wage of sampled job q and ϖ_q its sample weight, benchmarked so that the weights in a cell sum to the cell's employment E_i. The ratio of two such averages is therefore a change in the cell's wage bill per worker. We have no comparable weights, and dropping them does not leave an index in which listings count equally: (2) would then weight each listing by its own posted rate. Equation (1) is the formula that gives every matched listing an equal vote, which is why we adopt it.

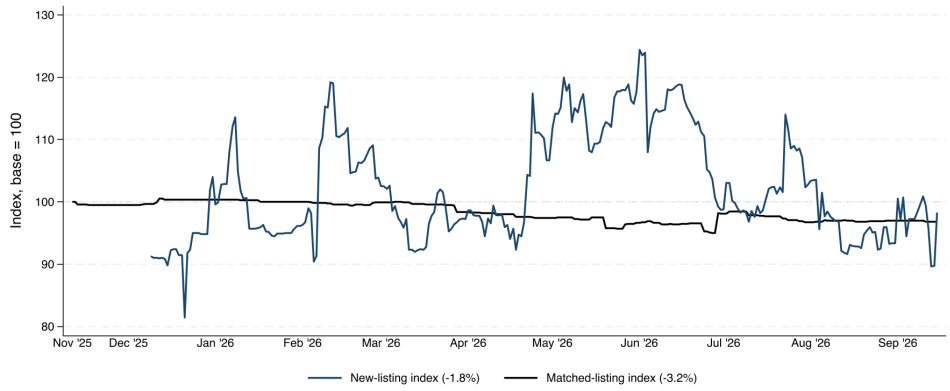
(iii) Prices and sample. The ECI records wages paid in sampled jobs, drawn with known probabilities and benchmarked to employment, so its cell averages estimate what the workers in a cell earn. We observe rates posted on one platform's public board, taking the midpoint of a range that averages 28 percent of its midpoint, for every listing rather than a sample. Our weights therefore carry no population interpretation: a domain's weight reflects the hiring that flowed through it, not an estimate of employment anywhere. Our cells are also far broader. The ECI's 765 cells fix both an occupational group and an industry, while our twelve domains fix neither, so a single domain can hold listings whose pay levels differ by an order of magnitude.

This is the second reason for (1) over (2): a ratio of average rates is defensible for homogeneous items and poorly behaved otherwise.

D.6 The new-listing index

The matched index is silent on the rates attached to listings that enter, since a listing must post on two consecutive days to be compared. The new-listing index in Figure 8 instead compares levels. A listing enters once, on the day it first appears, at its posted rate that day. Domain i's level on day t is the mean rate of the listings that entered in the previous 28 days over the mean rate of those that entered in the panel's first 90 days, geometric alongside (1) and arithmetic alongside (2). If no listing entered in those 28 days the level keeps its previous value. Within a domain every entrant counts equally, since a listing has no hiring history before it appears. Domain levels are averaged with the weights of (3), so unlike the matched index the new-listing index also moves when the weights move. Miscellaneous has no entrant in the first 90 days, so it has no base and is excluded.

Figure 8: Wage rates on continuing and newly listed jobs

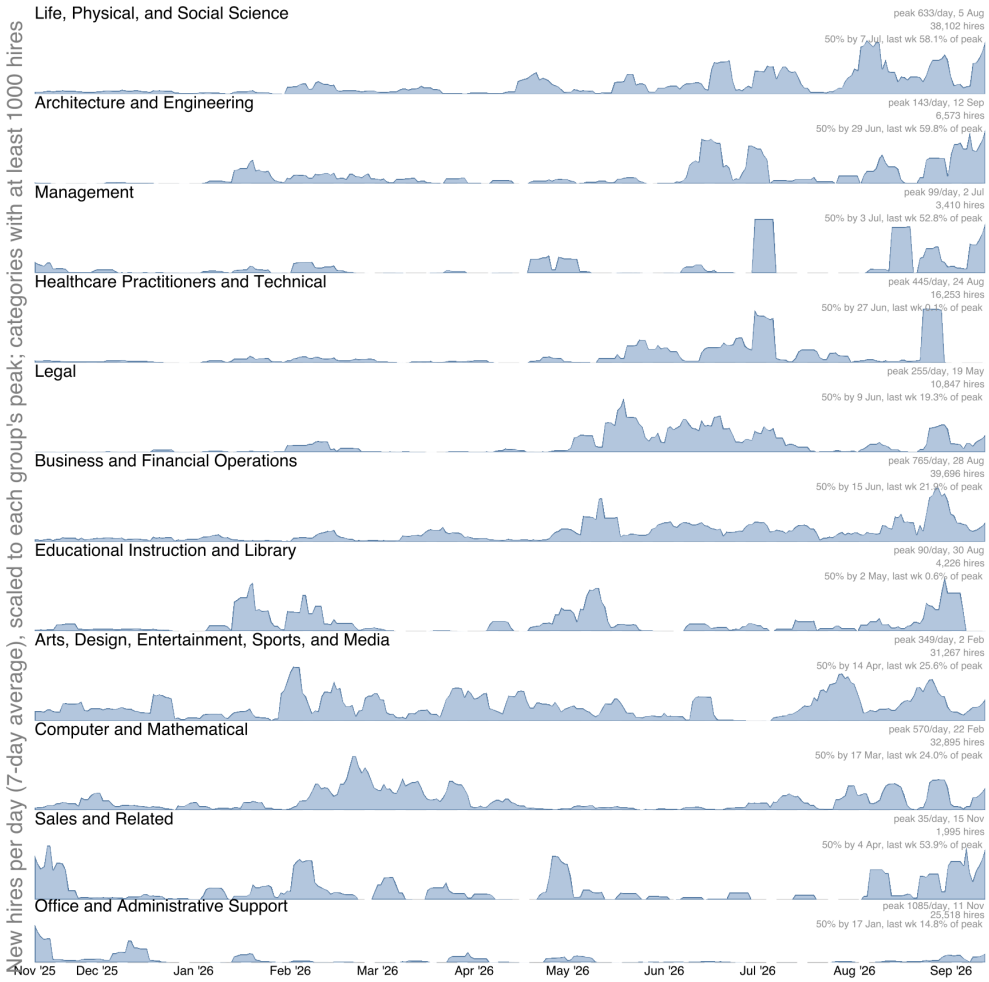


Notes: The matched-listing index compares posted hourly-equivalent rates for continuing listings and aggregates changes across expertise domains. The new-listing index measures the initial posted rate of listings first appearing within the trailing 28 days, aggregated across the same domains. Both aggregates weight each domain by its share of the wage bill of the hires made in the previous 120 days, Eq. (3).

E Market size and AI Adoption Measures

We show how total hires, prices, and total estimated spend correlate with Anthropic's measure of observed AI use, theoretical potential of AI, and the gap between theoretical and observed AI use. Figure 20 reports those correlations; Figure 5 reports the same exercise for the timing of each group's hiring wave.

Figure 9: Hiring waves by SOC major occupation group



Notes: The platform's public job board, November 11, 2025 to September 12, 2026. Each row is a SOC 2-digit major group with at least 1,000 hires over the panel (eleven groups). Each curve is the group's new hires per day (7-day centred moving average), measured as posting-level day-over-day increments of the "N hired this month" counter, adding back the hires that disappear from the counter after a month, and scaled to the group's own peak; postings are assigned to detailed SOC occupations from their titles and aggregated to major groups. Hires recorded on a posting's first appearance count on that day; for postings already live on the panel's first date, the day-one counter is spread evenly over its trailing window (Appendix A), and the row totals include those undated day-one hires. The right-hand labels report the peak daily hires of the plotted series and the day it is reached, the group's total hires over the panel, the day the group's cumulative dated hires reach half of their window total, and the mean daily rate over the panel's final seven days as a share of the peak. Groups are ordered by the hires-weighted mean date of hiring, latest at the top. The top rows are right-censored by the September 12 end of the panel.

Figure 10: Hiring waves by expertise domain, without the 7-day moving average



Notes: As Figure 1, without the 7-day smoothing: each row is the domain's raw daily hires, scaled to its own raw peak. The labelled peak level, its date, and the final-week share refer to this raw daily series; the day the domain reaches half of its hires does not depend on the smoothing.

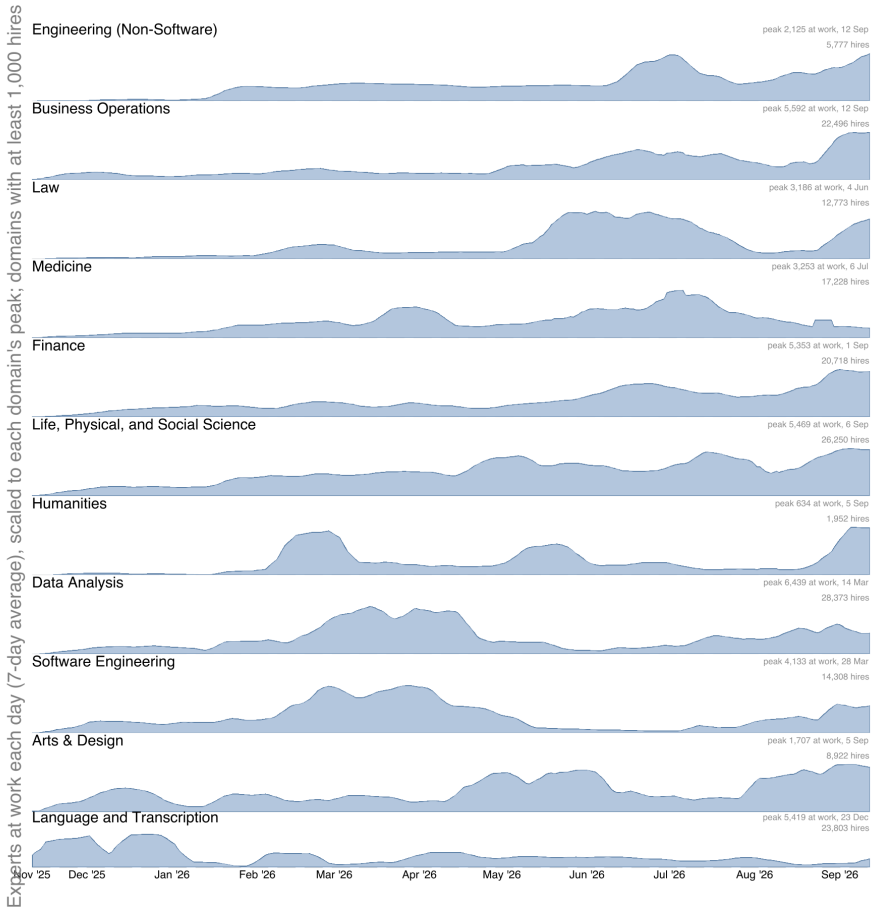


Figure 11: Experts on the job, at the lengths the postings state. Each dated hire occupies the days of its posting's engagement (Table 4, Panel A); the postings that fix no end take 23 days, the hires-weighted mean among those that do, except those stating a floor, which keep the floor. Curves are 7-day averages of the experts at work each day, scaled to each domain's peak; rows, sample and order as in Figure 1.

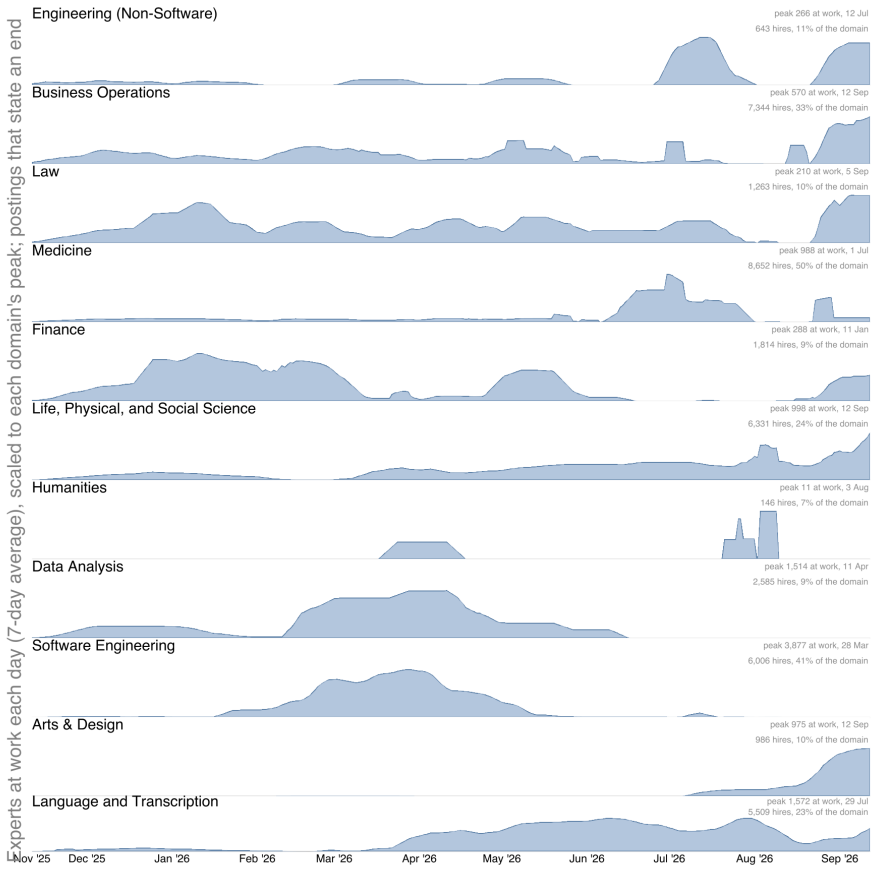


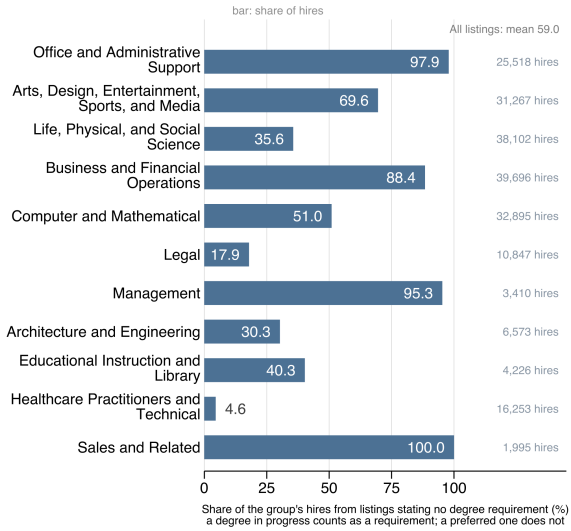
Figure 12: Experts on the job, postings that state an end. As Figure 11, restricted to the 491 postings that fix an end to the work (Table 4, Panel A: a single length, a range or total hours), which carry 21.6 percent of hires. Each dated hire occupies the days its posting states, so no length is assumed. Rows, order and scaling as in Figure 11; right-hand labels report the peak, its date, these postings' hires and their share of the domain's hires.

Table 4: Work Duration and Intensity

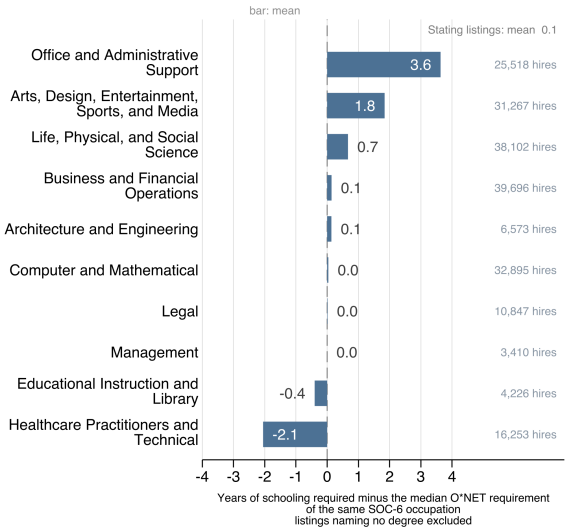
What the posting says	Postings	Hires (%)	What we take
Panel A. How long the work lasts			
No end to the work			
Nothing about length	1,498	58.0	the mean below, 23 days
Ongoing or long-term, no number	154	9.3	the mean below, 23 days
A minimum ("at least four weeks")	205	11.1	the floor
An end to the work			
A single length ("three months")	224	14.8	the number
A range ("one to two months")	240	6.8	the midpoint
Total hours only ("five hours total")	27	0.0	eight-hour days
States an end	**491**	**21.6**	**mean 23 days (hire-weighted)**
Panel B. Hours per week			
No intensity stated			
Nothing about intensity	1,075	47.3	the platform's field, then a 40-hour week
An intensity stated			
A minimum ("at least 10 hours")	495	22.2	the floor
A typical load ("10 to 20 hours")	658	23.9	the midpoint
A ceiling ("up to 40 hours")	114	6.5	the ceiling
A daily amount ("8 hours per day")	6	0.1	five such days
States an intensity	**1,273**	**52.7**	**median 20 hours (hire-weighted)**

Notes: The cleaned job board, one reading per posting, its last version; a posting relaunched under a new listing is read once. Within each panel the rows partition the 2,348 postings, and the percentages are shares of hires, not of postings: the 1,498 postings silent about length are 64 percent of postings but carry 58 percent of hires. The bold row totals the block above it. A posting whose whole work is a single survey, study or session counts as one day and sits in the single-length row; an office schedule ("9:00 to 5:30") is recorded as a daily amount.

Figure 13: Degree requirements and education gaps relative to the occupation's incumbents



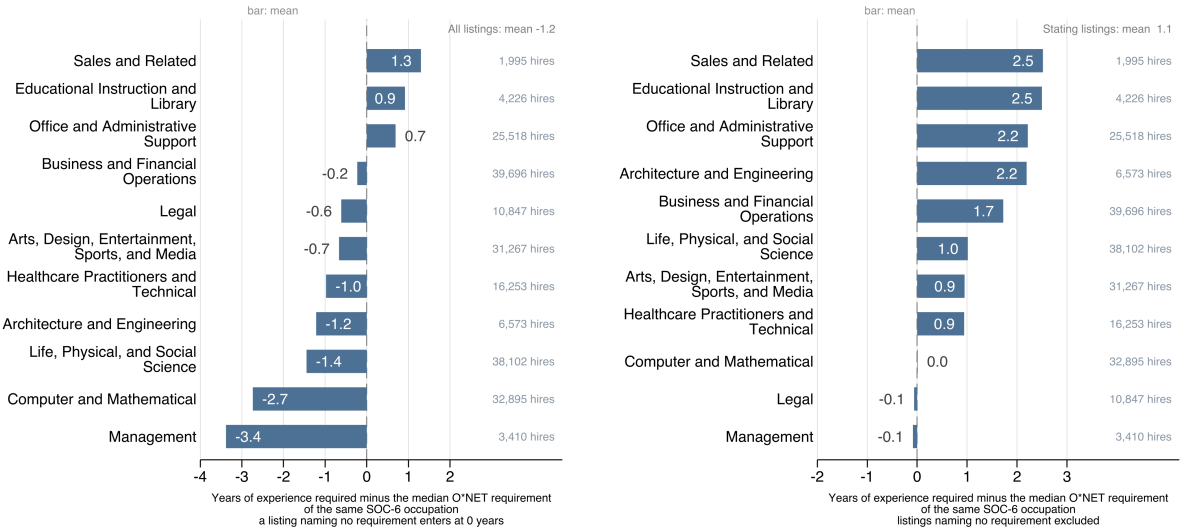
A. Share of hires from listings stating no degree requirement



B. Education gap among listings stating a requirement

Notes: This figure shows how often hires come from listings without degree requirements and how stated requirements compare with the education of occupational incumbents. Panel A shows the share of each group's hires from listings stating no degree requirement. A degree in progress counts as a requirement; a merely preferred degree does not. All listings enter panel A, regardless of O*NET coverage. Panel B shows the hire-weighted mean gap, in years of schooling, between a listing's stated requirement and the median incumbent's education in its SOC-6 occupation, as measured by the O*NET Education and Training Questionnaire, using only listings that state a requirement. Groups are the eleven SOC-2 majors with at least 1,000 hires. Rows follow panel B's order; Sales, which has no stating listings, appears last in panel A and has no bar in panel B. Corner statistics pool all listings eligible for each panel, and the right-hand columns report each group's total board hires in both panels.

Figure 14: Required experience against the occupation's incumbents, by SOC-2

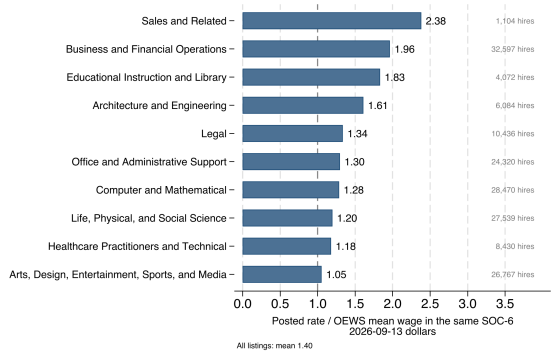


A. All listings, silence at zero years

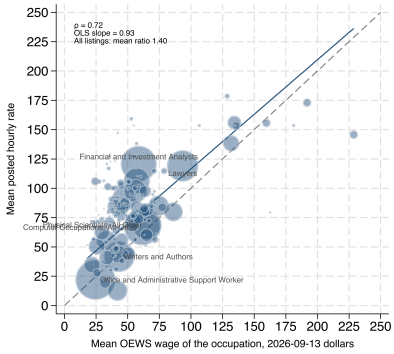
B. Listings stating a requirement

Notes: Each bar is the group's hire-weighted mean gap, in years, between the experience the listing requires and the median incumbent of its SOC-6 occupation in the O*NET related work experience question. In panel A a listing stating no requirement enters at zero years; panel B keeps only the listings that state one, against the same benchmark. Groups are the eleven SOC-2 majors with at least 1,000 hires; the corner statistic pools all listings, and the right column reports the group's board hires in both panels.

Figure 15: Posted pay against the US wage, by occupation



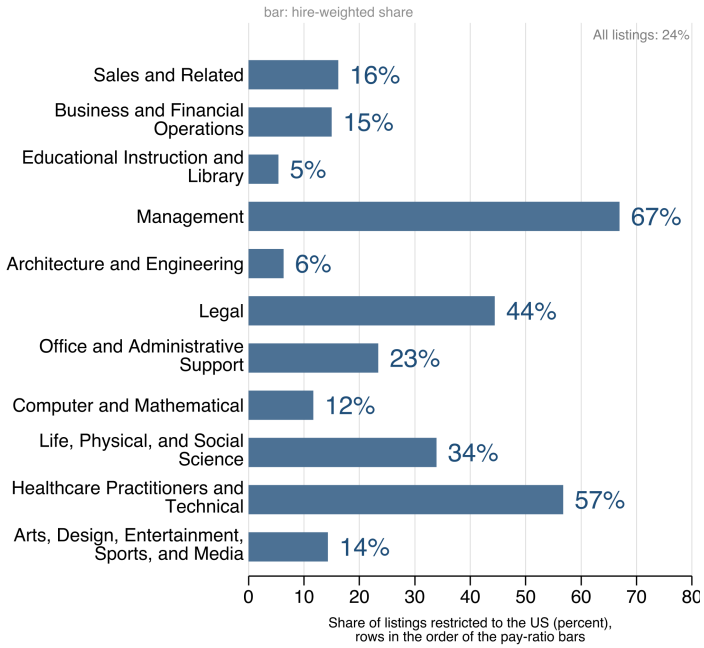
A. Mean pay ratio by SOC-2 (midpoint over OEWS mean), weighted by hires



B. Mean posted midpoint against the US mean wage, by SOC-6, weighted by hires

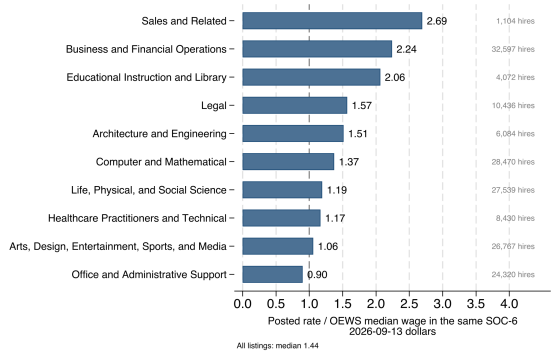
Notes: In panel B each marker's area scales with the occupation's hires; the dashed line is equal pay, the solid line the hire-weighted least-squares fit. The corner statistic in both panels is the same hire-weighted mean ratio, computed over all listings before the 1,000-hire cut.

Figure 16: Share of listings restricted to the US, by SOC-2

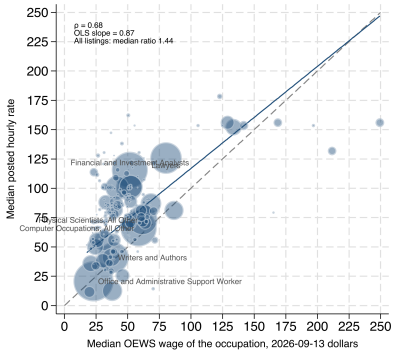


Notes: Hire-weighted share of listings restricted to the US, by SOC-2 major group. A listing counts as restricted when the platform's own eligible-country field names the US and no other country, or when the same reading comes from its description; the two sources overlap only in part, so either one on its own understates the share. Unlike Figure 15, no listing is set aside for the way it pays: postings priced per task or one-time carry 19 percent of the hires and are about twice as likely to be restricted to the US, so every listing of the group enters its bar. The rows keep the order of the pay-ratio bars of Figure 15A, not the order of the share, so the two figures read side by side; Management has a bar here and none there, because too few of its listings post a time rate to clear the 1,000-hire floor in that sample. The corner statistic pools all listings before the 1,000-hire cut.

Figure 17: Robustness: medians in place of means

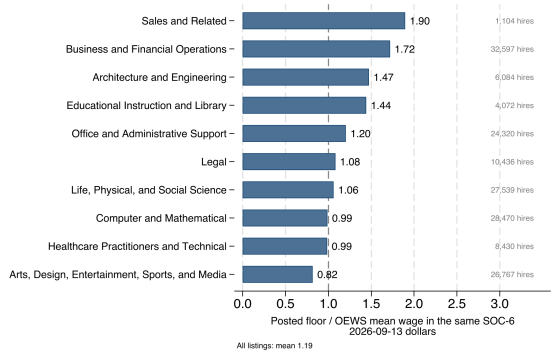


A. Median pay ratio by SOC-2 (midpoint over OEWS median), weighted by hires

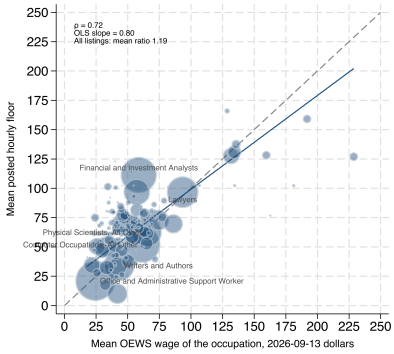


B. Median posted midpoint against the US median wage, by SOC-6, weighted by hires

Figure 18: Robustness: the floor of the posted range

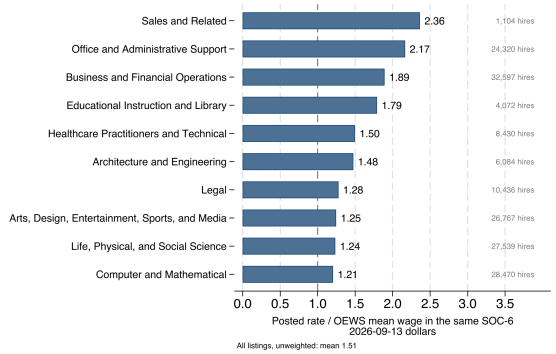


A. Mean pay ratio by SOC-2 (range floor over OEWS mean), weighted by hires

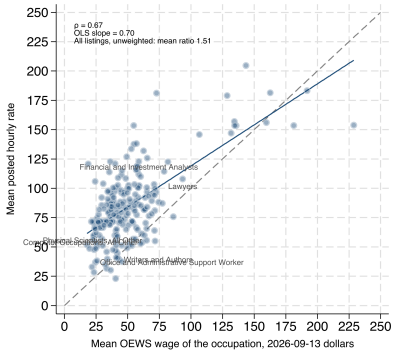


B. Mean posted floor against the US mean wage, by SOC-6, weighted by hires

Figure 19: Robustness: every listing weighted equally

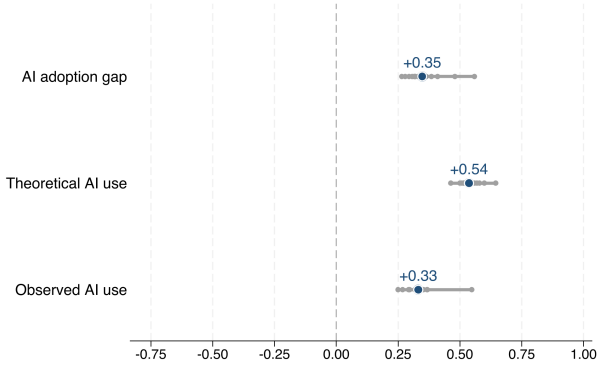


A. Mean pay ratio by SOC-2 (midpoint over OEWS mean), unweighted

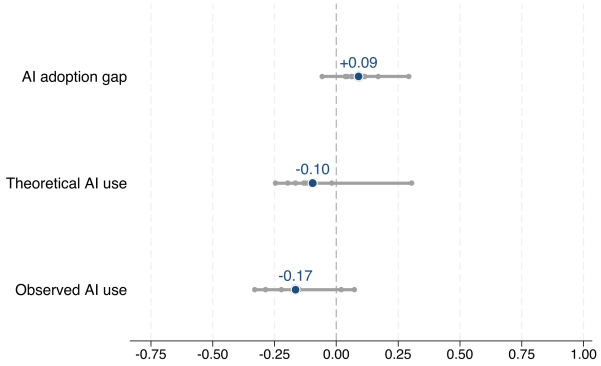


B. Mean posted midpoint against the US mean wage, by SOC-6, unweighted

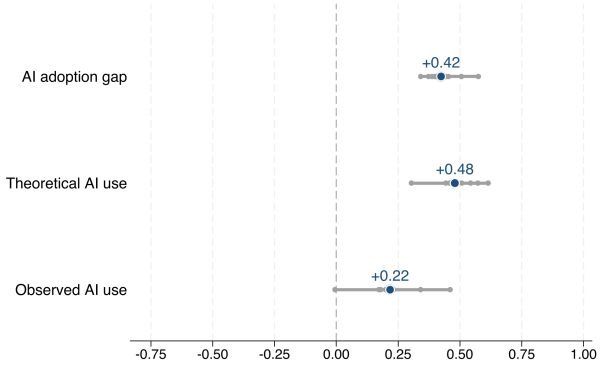
Figure 20: Correlation of market size and prices with AI-use measures



A. Total hires (log)



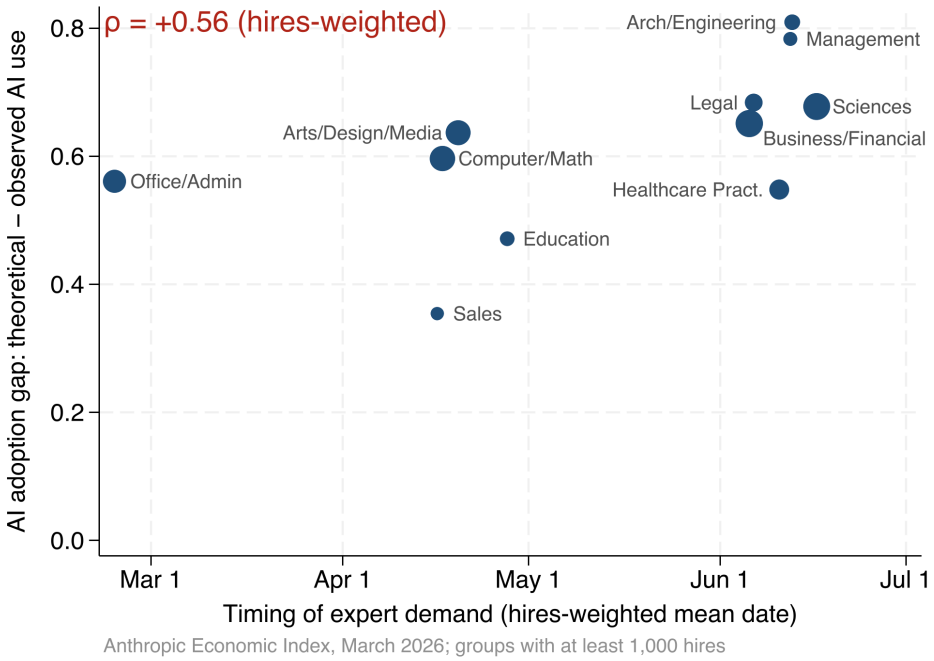
B. Median posted price (log)



C. Estimated spend (log)

Notes: Correlation between three market outcomes and the three AI-use measures of Figure 5, across the same twenty groups, likewise weighted by hires, and over the same November 11, 2025 to September 12, 2026 panel, with leave-one-out ranges constructed identically. Total hires and estimated spend are posting-level sums over each group's listings, in logs; the median price is the median posted midpoint across the group's hourly listings, in logs. Market size loads on theoretical exposure: hires correlate +0.54 with theoretical AI use against +0.35 with the adoption gap, while for estimated spend the two are close (+0.48 and +0.42) — groups where AI could absorb more work bought more expert labor and spent more. Posted prices are unrelated to all three measures (−0.17 to +0.09), with leave-one-out ranges that cross zero in every case.

Figure 21: Timing of expert hiring and the AI adoption gap, groups above 1,000 hires



Notes: Figure 4 restricted to the eleven major groups with at least 1,000 hires over the panel, the selection rule used elsewhere in the paper; axes, weighting and construction are otherwise identical. The nine groups this drops account for 2,038 hires, 1.0 percent of the total, so the weighted correlation barely moves, from +0.54 to +0.56.